Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

How to Keep an Eye on Your Own Mental Health

Mental health challenges can cloud our thinking, making it difficult to recognize when we're struggling. However, with a few strategies, you can catch warning signs before they escalate. (See the separate "Mental Health Warning Signs" handout for a list of signs to look out for.)

Use External Cues

- Set a recurring self-check-in (every two weeks, for example) where you review the list of warning signs.
- Stick to the routine, even if you feel fine — internal signals aren't always reliable.

Enlist a Trusted Person

- Ask a loved one, close friend, or therapist to keep an eye out for warning signs. They can see things you might miss when you're not in the best state of mind.

Learn Your "Tells"

- Recognize your personal patterns of distorted thinking or self-talk. These can act as red flags when they show up during difficult times, signaling that your mental health may need attention.
- For example, if you often think "I'm a failure" when stressed, that might be one of your tells.

Notice When Thoughts "Overplay Their Hand"

- Sometimes, distorted thoughts give themselves away by becoming implausibly extreme. For example, "You've never done anything right in your life."
- Use those moments of "overreach" as a signal to check in on your mental health.